

Team Training — Session 47

Less Talking. More Doing.

Value Always Wins.

Marketing Sweet · Whole-team training

WHAT THIS SESSION IS Activity is not progress. Communication is not the product. Results are. This session is about the difference between people who look busy and people who create value — across sales, CS, production, management, and admin. Every role. Same lesson.

1. Activity vs value — the confusion that costs businesses

Every business — including this one — has to actively guard against the confusion between activity and progress. More meetings, more calls, more emails, more conversations. On the surface it looks like a business working hard. Underneath, it can be a business optimising for the wrong thing.

Clients don't pay for activity. They pay for improvement. The distinction sounds obvious in a training room. In daily practice, it collapses constantly — because activity is easy to measure and value is not. Reps count calls. CS counts touchpoints. Production counts hours. None of those numbers, on their own, tell anyone whether the client's business is actually better than it was last month.

"Clients don't pay us to stay busy. They pay us to improve their business. There's a very big difference between the two."

2. The "I haven't heard from you" conversation

A conversation that lands regularly: "I haven't heard from you in six months. I used to hear from Johnny every two weeks. Have you changed your client management process?" Yes. We have. Because we're always looking for better ways to serve clients — and "better" is defined by outcome, not by frequency.

The old rhythm — a call every two weeks whether there was anything meaningful to report or not — was well-intentioned and structurally lazy. It made the business look attentive without requiring the business to be attentive. The revised approach is harder: understand what each client actually values, then deliver against that.

3. Every client is different — and that's the whole point

Does every client want a phone call every two weeks? No. Some love the regular touch. Some are so busy they'd rather hear from us only when there's genuine progress to report. Some prefer a monthly update. Some quarterly. Some simply want to know we're there whenever they need us.

Great service isn't treating every client identically. It's understanding what each client values most, then serving them that way. Uniform service is efficient; personalised service is valuable. The uniformity feels safer to the business. The personalisation feels better to the client.

"Great customer service isn't treating every client the same. It's understanding what each client values most."

4. The core rule — results are the product

Communication isn't the product. Results are. If we've spent the month improving rankings, building pages, fixing technical issues, strengthening a website, or generating opportunities — that's value. A phone call by itself doesn't create value. The work does.

This doesn't diminish communication. Communication matters — enormously. But its role is to support great work, not replace it. There's a huge difference between ringing a client to say "here's what we achieved this month" and ringing because the calendar told you to. Clients remember outcomes. They forget conversations.

"I'd much rather ring a client and say 'here's everything we've achieved for you' than ring simply because the calendar says I should. Clients remember outcomes. Not conversations."

5. The same rule inside sales — the polite "no"

The most common early objection in sales lands in three flavours: "we've already got someone," "a friend handles that," "someone in the office does it." Many reps hear these as real objections and start arguing against them. Almost every time, that's the wrong read.

Most of the time these are polite versions of "I'm not interested right now." And that's fine. Not every conversation is supposed to become a sale. Reps who understand this stop wasting energy trying to convert the polite-no and start asking better questions of the prospects who actually want to talk.

6. Investigate, don't argue

Instead of arguing, be curious. Ask better questions. Five that consistently open real conversations:

1. Can the business actually take on more work right now?
2. Where do most of your current enquiries come from?
3. When was the last time you properly reviewed the website?
4. Are you happy with where the business is today, or do you want to grow it?
5. If growth is the plan, what does that actually look like over the next 12 months?

These questions do the work an argument can't. They give the prospect space to think out loud, and they give the rep the information needed to decide whether there's a real conversation worth having.

7. Tell the truth — even when it's uncomfortable

Curiosity doesn't mean softness. If a genuine problem is identified — an outdated website, credibility damage, opportunities being lost — the professional answer is to say so.

Not to scare. Not to pressure. Because that's what professionals do. Clients don't need another vendor telling them everything looks fine. They need someone prepared to tell them the truth and help them fix it. That's how real trust is built — and it's the opposite of the sales stereotype most prospects walk in expecting.

"Clients don't need another person telling them everything is fine. They need someone prepared to tell them the truth — and help them fix it."

8. What we actually sell

We don't sell websites. We don't sell SEO. We don't sell marketing. We solve business problems. Every recommendation, every strategy, every improvement should answer one question: "Will this genuinely improve the client's business?" If the answer is yes, stand behind it.

Confidence doesn't come from memorising scripts. It comes from belief that what's being recommended is actually going to help. When you genuinely believe you're helping someone, people feel it. When you don't believe it, they feel that too.

9. Notice the wins — momentum is fuel

A pattern worth naming: people are quick to talk about problems. Something goes wrong — everyone knows. A client is unhappy — everyone hears about it. Someone leaves the business — it becomes the topic of conversation.

The wins get less airtime. Projects completed. Client rankings improved. Processes tightened. Systems strengthened. Teams becoming more disciplined. Work delivered that clients don't even see. That's progress. If the only thing anyone talks about is what's wrong, the culture loses sight of what's going right — and momentum quietly collapses.

"Momentum creates belief. Belief creates confidence. Confidence creates better conversations. And better conversations create better client experiences."

10. Mindset — dreams and noise cannot occupy the same space

Every day brings noise. A difficult client. A lost sale. Someone saying no. Someone questioning your ability. A project that doesn't go to plan. A bad day. A bad week. It's all noise.

The mistake is believing the noise defines the future. It doesn't. What defines the future is the direction you're pointed in — the dream, the goal, the version of the career or business you're actually building toward. Successful people aren't people who avoid setbacks. They're people who refuse to let setbacks change where they're going.

11. Blind faith — the right kind

Blind faith is misunderstood. It isn't a belief that everything will go perfectly. It won't. There will be difficult conversations. There will be lost clients. There will be mistakes. There will be self-doubt. That's normal.

Blind faith is the belief that if you continue improving, continue learning, continue showing up, continue doing the work — eventually the results will come. Because results are simply a delayed reaction to consistent habits. The work always comes first. The rewards come later. Reps who understand the delay don't quit during it.

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12. Own your strengths — stop comparing

Comparison is one of the largest drains on personal energy in any team. Everyone has different strengths. Some are analytical. Some are natural communicators. Some are visionary. Some are relentless. Some are disciplined. Some simply refuse to quit.

The invitation is to find your strength, own it, develop it — instead of wasting time wishing you had someone else's gifts. Become exceptional at what you're already built for.

13. Growth is invisible from the inside

Growth is never instant, and it always feels slower from the inside than it looks from the outside. One difficult day feels enormous. One difficult client feels overwhelming. One bad month feels like it will never end.

Zoom out and those moments become tiny. Every difficult conversation prepares the next one. Every objection sharpens communication. Every challenge builds resilience. Every setback teaches something worth being grateful for later. Growth happens because of adversity — not in the absence of it.

14. Today's challenge

Stop measuring your contribution by how busy you are. Measure it by the value you've created. Six questions to sit with at the end of the day:

- Did I solve a problem today?
- Did I improve a client's business?
- Did I help a teammate?
- Did I make a process better?
- Did I leave something better than I found it?
- Did I create anything the client will actually remember?

Activity without outcomes is just movement. Value is what people remember.

"Less talking. More doing. Value always wins."

Action items — this week

1. Audit one client. Pick one you serve regularly. Ask yourself honestly: what value have we actually created for them in the last 30 days? Not calls made — outcomes delivered.
2. Ask, don't assume, on communication rhythm. Rather than defaulting to the calendar, ask one client how often they'd genuinely like to hear from us and in what form.
3. Notice one win publicly. Something the team achieved, or a colleague delivered, that would normally go unremarked. Say it out loud.
4. On the next polite "no," stop arguing. Ask one of the five investigation questions instead — and see what the prospect actually says.
5. End the day with the six-question check. Write the answers down. If most of them are "no," the day was activity, not value — and tomorrow's plan needs to change.